

PLANNING YOUR PUBLIC SERVICE ANNOUNCEMENT



Lesson 15

 In this activity, you will plan and organize an effective **public service announcement** regarding substance use. You will identify your **target audience** and craft a **persuasive message** to share with your community.



Key Terms

Term	Definition
Public Service Announcement (PSA)	A short message created to share information or influence the public to take action.
Target Audience	The specific group of people that a message is intended to reach.
Substance Use	The act of using drugs or alcohol in ways that can affect health and safety.
Resource	A place, service, or person that provides support or help when needed.



Read and Analyze PSA Goals

Read the following information carefully. As you read, ask yourself: **How does a clear message help influence the decisions of others regarding their health?**

Public service announcements are powerful tools for health education. To create one, you must first define your target audience, such as your peers or parents. Next, craft a concise message that identifies the issue and provides a clear call to action.

Including accurate data, such as a surprising health fact, adds credibility to your message. Finally, always provide a verified resource or help message so that the audience knows exactly where to turn if they need assistance or support.



Think, Pair, Share

Complete the table below by answering the questions yourself. Then, connect with a partner to discuss your ideas.

Question	Your Answer	Your Partner's Answer
What are the four essential components identified in the text that a strong PSA must include to be effective for the target audience?		
Why is it important to provide a specific resource or help message at the end of a PSA about substance use for your peers?		
How does combining a factual health statistic with a direct call to action create a more persuasive message than just stating a fact alone?		

Prepare what you and your partner will share. **What was similar, different, or noteworthy about your answers?**

We noticed that...